

versus \$1,200 for a new set of window coverings, which would you choose? What is your cutoff amount for a savings to be worth your while? For me, anything I would be thrilled to receive as a percentage rate on a savings or investment account has my full attention.

11. Accept the power of secondhand shopping

If you can incorporate secondhand purchases into your lifestyle even minimally, it will make an enormous difference to your overall financial picture. I've previously gone for more than five years without paying over \$10 for any single outfit. Many cost far less than that. It isn't necessarily fun, easy, or even something most people would feel comfortable with. It was something extreme that I felt was worth it for early retirement. If secondhand clothing is not something you are willing to explore, consider other secondhand items that are in your comfort zone: power tools, automobiles, non-upholstered furniture, a home, appliances, etc. Get the picture? Larger-ticket items can make a huge difference when purchased secondhand. The savings can add up to a staggering amount in a hurry.

The bottom line is that by treating shopping as a job and responsibility

instead of a recreational activity, we all have the power to take more control over our financial futures.

— Myscha Theriault

5 Marketing Ploys Grocery Stores Use to Steal Your Money

The cost of food isn't going down, and for some, it is making the task of feeding a family more painful than ever. It doesn't help that ad agencies and PR companies are getting better at creating snazzy gimmicks to get you to buy. Instead of providing you with better food at larger quantities, some of them are selling slicker packaging and empty promises. Here's a look at some of the biggest marketing trends designed to keep you spending.

1. Preportioned food

I'll admit that it is very tempting to snag one of those 100-calorie snack